

Natali Katz

Artist, animator, and game designer

V3H0M4

natewiesel@gmail.com

+16048305044

Professional Summary

- US/Canada dual citizen, located in Port Moody, BC.
- Skilled in various creative and technical fields with a primary focus on game design.
- Demonstrated ability to develop and ship solo projects, as well as collaborate effectively within small teams.
- Enjoys tackling the challenge of breaking down complex problems into their essential components.
- Experimented in lots of genres, styles, and game mechanics, and tries to learn something with each project.
- Experienced in GameMaker programming (GML) with years of expertise, as well as familiarity with professional engines like Unreal and Unity.
- Wide variety of art skills. This includes fine arts (painting, caricature) and game asset creation (Pixel art, UI design, 2D/3D art, and even some 2D Animation.)

Willing to relocate to: Vancouver, BC - Burnaby, BC

Work Experience

Company Owner, Game Developer/Artist/Designer/Programmer

Studio Cozy Zone-Port Moody, BC

July 2025 to Present

Studio Cozy Zone's primary goal is to create video games that push boundaries, shatter conventions, and engage in conversation with the audience. It focuses on creating an inviting environment for artists and designers alike, in order to give team members control and ownership over their work, as well as genuine creative fulfillment.

I am the Sole Proprietor of Studio Cozy Zone, and my responsibilities include:

- All disciplines involved with creating video games (programming, design, art, UI, sound, etc.)
- Reaching out to potential partners, publishers, grants, and other funding opportunities.
- Maintaining a presence on social media, and digital storefronts such as Steam and Itch.io.
- Attending and running booths at various in-person events and expos.

Game Developer

81monkeys Game Studios Inc-Port Moody, BC

April 2024 to July 2025

- Became the sole developer of a small GameMaker project within 81monkeys between April and July 2024. I was trusted to jump between disciplines as needed, and was able to apply my skillset in many dynamic ways. I took on game/mechanics/UI design, programming, art, and sound, and documented my goals at each step.
- Later in 2024, the studio was ramping up development on a work-for-hire game (a role-playing game for PC and Mobile platforms) for a major fast food brand. I voluntarily pivoted my work towards aiding the team with sound design for the project, and eventually took on some small programming tasks as well as designing new areas, writing dialogue, balancing weapon/enemy stats, and QA testing.

- Provided consultation during meetings for the primary project "World of Anterra" at 81monkeys. I was also responsible for the pitch that resulted in the game's initial story direction, including some of the "iconic" elements that remain a staple of the project to this day.

Refining and learning new art skills (2D & 3D) and designing video games solo/in teams

Self-Employed-Albuquerque, NM

June 2019 to April 2024

While I hadn't worked for a company in a while, I spent the period between jobs taking on new skills and challenging myself. This includes:

- Learned the workflow of 3D art in Blender. This includes Modeling, UV Unwrapping, Texturing/Shading, Rigging, Rendering, and basic animation.
- Familiarized myself with Unreal Engine 4, in particular how to program with Blueprints.
- Shipped a large solo game project "Flowerdrops." It's a Peggle-inspired puzzler with a uniquely relaxing vibe, and lots of different game mechanics to discover and explore.
- Successfully developed and released a horror game, "ODR: The Sunken Flesh," as the primary programmer and artist for a Liminal Space themed game jam, completing the project within a challenging 5-week timeframe. Designed and implemented all gameplay systems, including producing 3D models and animations, as well as applying textures and decals to create a captivating game world.
- Designed T-Shirts that were sold via The Yetee
- Continued building upon a strong foundation of art, refining my Fine Arts skills in particular, and creating vibrant and emotional paintings that I'm proud to share.
- Learned a variety of web design conventions in order to make a professional-feeling portfolio website. As a result the website scales properly & displays nicely between desktop, tablet, and mobile.

Artist/Animator/UI Designer

81monkeys-Anmore, BC

January 2017 to January 2019

Created art assets, animations, and UI elements/layouts for mobile and PC games. My primary work included:

- Created over a hundred unlockable animated avatars for "Sudoku Scramble." They were created using Adobe Flash/Animate.
- Created Pixel Art assets for a chore-management app for parents.
- Designed & created final art assets for several UI elements that were in both aforementioned games.
- Trailer/advertisement editing and production
- Logo design and conceptualization
- Created & presented pitches for future game projects.

Lead Artist

The Layabouts LLC

February 2010 to July 2015

The Layabouts was a small independent game studio that I co-founded in 2010. I worked on a variety of game projects, as an artist, designer, and programmer.

Education

Game Design & Art

Art Institute of Vancouver-Vancouver, BC

October 2015 to March 2017

2D Animation

SUVA NM-Albuquerque, NM

August 2013 to December 2014

Skills

- Game Design
- Blender
- Adobe Photoshop
- Adobe Creative Suite
- Git
- UI
- Unity
- Video editing
- Visual Design
- Clip Studio Paint
- Unreal Engine
- Adobe Premiere
- GameMaker Studio
- Adobe Animate
- Adobe Flash